

What is it?

People with allergic contact dermatitis can be so sensitive to their allergen that they must avoid skin exposure AND ingestion (eating) of the chemical. This type of allergy could cause dermatitis on the eyelids, hands, face, around the mouth, or at the skin folds (armpits, groin). Some people may have dermatitis all over their bodies.

For some people allergic to cobalt, a diet low in cobalt can reduce the likelihood of skin reactions. The level of cobalt required to produce a response is unknown and can vary from patient to patient. A two-month trial of removing foods and beverages that contain cobalt is recommended.

The goal is a low-cobalt diet. In general, avoid anything with brazil nuts, cow liver, and homeopathic/herbal remedies.

There are two methods to avoid cobalt in your diet:

- Use the table below to count points
- Use the free app “Cobalt Companion”

References

Contact Dermatitis 2008;59:361-365.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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Cobalt Diet



Low Cobalt Point-Based Diet

Guidelines for Use:

1. Adults should limit daily intake to no more than 12 points per day. The point total may need to be lowered in smokers.
2. Synthetically derived preparations of vitamin B12, including cyanocobalamin and hydroxocobalamin, contain cobalt and may cause a skin reaction in people allergic to cobalt.
3. A multivitamin counts as 2 points.
4. Vitamin B12 occurring naturally in foods, adenosylcobalamin and methylcobalamin, is not known to cause skin reactions.

Points	Food	Serving Size American	Serving Size Metric
1	Apple juice	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Apricots	1 fruit or 1.4 oz	38 g
	Asparagus	Half of a cup	67 g or 112 ml
	Avocado	Quarter of a fruit, 2.2 oz	60.5 g
	Bagel	1 bagel or 4.3 oz	120 g
	Beef (steak, rump, chuck, roast, sirloin, round)	4 oz	113 g
	Beef bouillon soup	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Beef taco	1 taco or 3.6 oz	100 g
	Breakfast sandwich (egg, cheese, ham)	1 sandwich or 5 oz	139 g
	Broccoli	Half of a cup	44 g or 112 ml
	Cashews	1 oz	28 g
	Chicken noodle casserole	4 oz	113 g
	Chicken noodle soup	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Chocolate chip cookies	1 cookie or 0.5 oz	14 g
	Cod/haddock fillet	4 oz	113 g
	English muffin	1 cup	57 g
	Fish sticks and patties	4 oz	113 g
	Granola cereal	Half of a cup	30 g or 112 ml
	Grape juice	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Green beans	Half of a cup	55 g or 112 ml
	Instant mashed potatoes	Half of a cup	105 g or 112 ml
	Lima beans	Half of a cup	55 g or 112 ml
	Multigrain/whole wheat/cracked wheat bread	1 slice or 1.5 oz	43 g
	Mushroom soup	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Oat bran cereal	Half of a cup	35 g or 112 ml
	Onion rings	1 small or 3 oz	84 g
	Peanuts	1 oz	28 g
	Pears	Half of a fruit or 3.2 oz	90 g
	Pecans	1 oz	28 g
	Potato chips	1 oz	28 g

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Cobalt Diet



Points	Food	Serving Size American	Serving Size Metric
1 Cont.	Prunes	Half of a cup	85 g or 112 ml
	Rye bread	1 slice	37 g
	Salisbury steak TV dinner	Half of a dinner, 6.5 oz	182 g
	Soy sausage	2- to 4-inch links or 1.2 oz	2- to 10-cm links or 34 g
	Stuffed green peppers	Half of a stuffed pepper or	110 g
	Sweet potato	Half of a cup	78 g or 112 ml
	Tempeh	4 oz	113 g
	Turkey TV dinner	Half of a dinner or 6 oz	165 g
	Wholemeal flour	Quarter of a cup	30 g or 66 ml
	Squash	Half of a cup	57 g or 112 ml
2	Alfalfa	1 oz	28 g
	Almonds	1 oz	28 g
	Brownies	1 brownie or 3 x 1 x 1 in	24 g or 7.5 x 2.5 x 2.5 cm
	Cantaloupe	Half of a cup	80 g or 112 g
	Chicken TV dinner	Half of a dinner or 5.5 oz	154 g
	Chocolate pudding	Quarter of a cup	70 g or 66 ml
	Chocolate syrup	1 tablespoon	16 g or 15 ml
	Crisped rice cereal	1 cup	33 g or 224 ml
	Fruit flavoured cereal	1 cup	30 g or 224 ml
	Ground beef (hamburger patty, meatloaf)	4 oz	113 g
	Lentils	2 tablespoons	13 g or 30 ml
	Multivitamin	1 tablet	1.5 g
	Navy beans	Half of a cup	93 g or 112 ml
	Nutrigrain bar	1 bar or 1.3 oz	37 g
	Oysters	3 oz	84 g
	Peas	Half of a cup	73 g or 112 ml
	Pepitas	1 oz	28 g
	Prune juice	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Pumpkin	Half of a cup	58 g or 112 ml
	Raisin bran cereal	Half of a cup	30 g or 113
	Red wine	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Shrimp	3 oz	84 g
	Strawberries	Half of a cup	72 g or 112 ml
	Tomato juice	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Walnuts	1 oz	28 g

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Points	Food	Serving Size American	Serving Size Metric
3	Baked beans	Half of a cup	93 g or 112 ml
	Bean soup	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Chocolate	1 oz	28 g
	Chocolate ice cream	Half of a cup	100 g or 112 ml
	French fries	1 small or 3 oz	84 g
	Kidney beans	Half of a cup	93 g or 112 ml
	Oat ring cereal	1 cup	30 g or 224 ml
	Pizza	Quarter of 12 inch pie	130 g or quarter of 30 cm
	Potato	Half of a cup	78 g or 112 ml
	Rice bran	2 tablespoons	15 g or 30 ml
	Soy nuts cereal	1 cup	40 g or 224 ml
	Tahini	2 tablespoons	32 g or 30 ml
	Tofu	4 oz	113 g
	Veal (cutlets)	4 oz	113 g
	Wheat bran cereal	Half of a cup	31 g or 112 ml
	Yeast products (pastes, brewers, vegemite, marmite)	1 teaspoon	5 g or 5 ml
5	Buckwheat	2 tablespoons	15 g or 30 ml
	Chili with meat and beans	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Chocolate cake	3 x 3 x 2 inch	95 g or 7.5 x 7.5 x 5 cm
	Chocolate Milk	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Chocolate milk shake	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Chocolate powder drink mix	1 packet or 1.3 oz	36 g
	Clam chowder soup	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Lamb kidney	4 oz	113 g
	Millet seeds	2 tablespoons	13 g or 30 ml
	Mixed nuts without peanuts	1 oz	28 g
	Pinto beans	Half of a cup	93 g or 112 ml
	Soy milk	1 cup	240 g or 224 ml
	Sunflower kernels	1 oz	28 g
	Flaxseeds	2 tablespoons	13 g or 30 ml
7	Garbanzo beans/chickpeas	Half of a cup	93 g or 112 ml
	Lamb liver	4 oz	113 g
	Brazil nuts	1 oz	28 g
AVOID	Cow liver	4 oz	113 g
	Homeopathic/Herbal Remedies		

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